BIAN

Biozeen Industry Academy Network

USER GUIDE

Developers

For: Developer accounts (feature control)

Version of 26 October 2026

For: holders of a **developer account**. A developer account is not a role. It never appears in Roles & Permissions, the member lists or the admin audit log, and administrators cannot edit or suspend it. Developers can use everything, including the admin workspace, plus the **Developer console**.

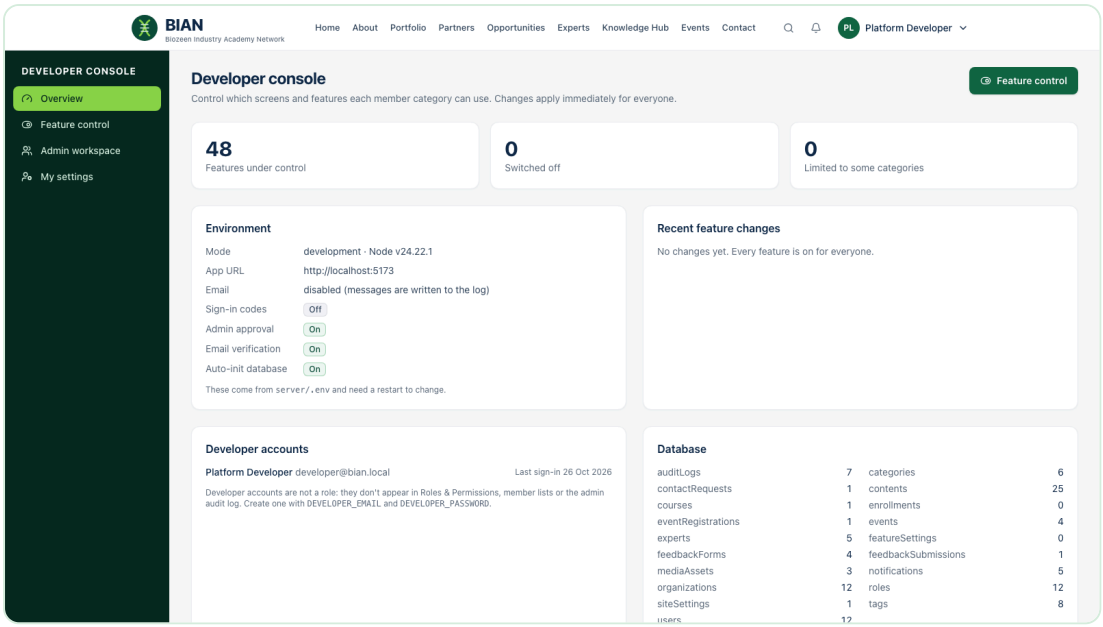
Get a developer account

Developer accounts are created on the server, not in the app. Set these in `server/.env` and restart the API:

```
DEVELOPER_EMAIL=you@example.com
DEVELOPER_PASSWORD=a-long-unique-password
```

The account is created on the next start if it doesn't exist. An existing ordinary account with that email is **never** promoted, so nobody can claim developer access by registering first. Sign in as usual; you land on the **Developer console** (`/developer`).

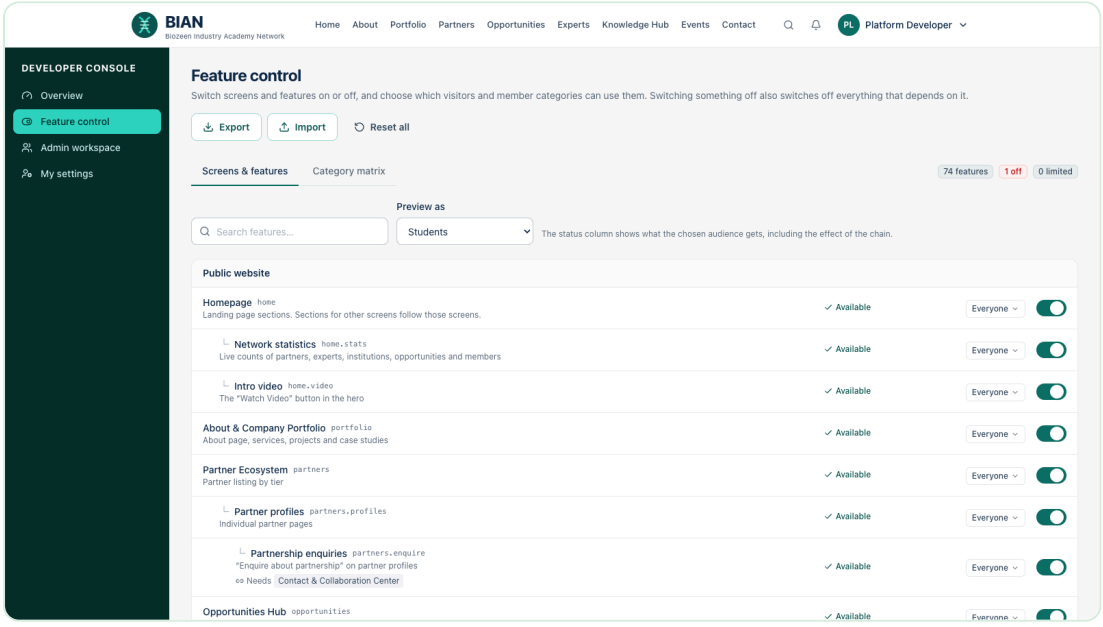
Overview



The developer console overview

Shows how many features are switched off or limited, the server's environment settings (email, sign-in codes, approval rules), recent feature changes, developer accounts and database collection sizes.

Feature control



Feature control

Every screen and feature is listed under six groups: **Public website**, **Member portal**, **Across the platform**, **Publishing workflow**, **Page builder** and **Admin workspace**. Features are nested under the screen they belong to.

- **Publishing workflow** covers each status an editor can choose (Drafts, Review & approval, Scheduled publishing, Unpublish, Archive), expiry dates, the editor's Preview tab, SEO settings and homepage featuring. *Published* is always available. Switching off Review & approval also stops members posting opportunities, because their posts need review.

- **Page builder** covers each family of blocks: media, file downloads, layout, call-to-action, related content and inline feedback. Switched-off blocks disappear from the editor's block menu and from published pages; existing blocks are kept and come back when the feature is switched on.
- **Admin workspace** includes each admin screen plus finer tools: overview analytics, CSV exports, registration lists, notes and assignment on requests, replies to members, feedback by member and the alumni database.

For each feature you can:

- **Switch it on or off** with the switch on the right. Off means off for everyone except developers, including administrators.
- **Limit who can use it** with the audience menu: *Visitors* and each member category (Startups, Academia, Industry, Experts (SME), Alumni, Students, Professionals, Other members). Features that need a signed-in member don't offer *Visitors*. Admin-workspace features are on/off only. Staff with admin access are not limited by audience, because they manage the content.

The chain

A feature is available only when it, the screen it sits under, and everything it **Needs** are all available. For example:

- Switching off **Contact & Collaboration Center** also switches off *Partnership enquiries*, *Request introductions*, *Requests & Messages* and the admin *Requests inbox*.
- Switching off **Member Portal** switches off everything members do from their dashboard, such as posting requirements, enrolling in courses and registering for events.
- Limiting **Experts Network** to *Industry* hides expert search, expert self-service and introductions for every other category.

Before you switch off something others depend on, a panel lists every feature that will stop working. Their own settings are kept, so they return when you switch the parent back on.

Preview as shows the *Status* column for any audience, so you can see exactly what a student, a visitor or staff will get, and which link in the chain is responsible.

Category matrix

The **Category matrix** tab shows every feature against every audience: ✓ available, × blocked by its own setting, – blocked by something it depends on. Click a cell to allow or block that audience.

Export, import and reset

- **Export** downloads the current configuration as JSON, for example to copy it to another environment.
- **Import** applies a configuration file. It replaces every current setting.
- **Reset all** switches everything back on for everyone.

What members see

Changes apply immediately. Open sessions update live: menu items, buttons and page sections for switched-off features disappear. Opening a switched-off page directly shows "This section is not available". The API enforces the same rules, so a switched-off feature can't be used by calling the API either.

Good practice

- Make changes in a quiet period and check them with **Preview as** before announcing.
- Export the configuration before large changes so you can import it back.
- Keep at least one developer account's password in a password manager. There is no in-app reset for developer accounts beyond the normal "Forgot password" email.

Things everyone can do

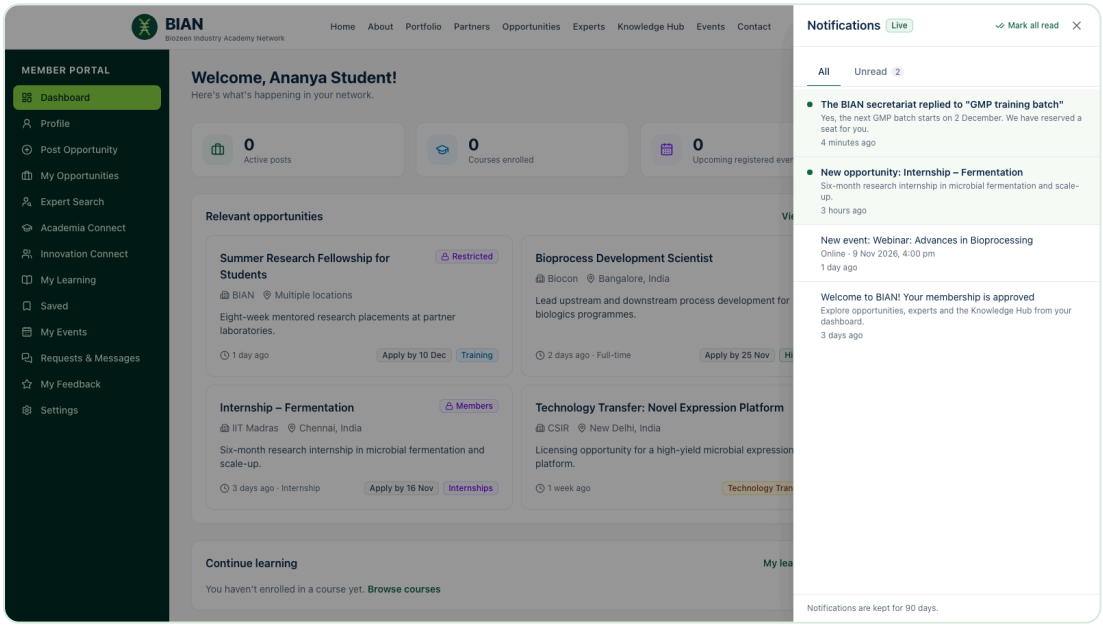
Sign in

1. Go to **Login** (top right) and enter your email and password. Tick **Remember me** on your own device to stay signed in for 30 days; otherwise you stay signed in for one day.
2. **If a sign-in code is asked for**, check your email for a 6-digit code and type it in. The code expires after 10 minutes. You can request a new one with **Resend code** (after 30 seconds). After 5 wrong codes, start again from the password step.
3. You land on your **Member Portal** (`/dashboard`), or on the **Admin workspace** (`/admin`) if you are staff.

Forgot your password? Use **Forgot Password?** on the login page. The emailed link is valid for one hour.

> Whether a sign-in code is required is set by your administrator. Until email is set up, the platform shows codes and links on screen in development only. Live sites must have email configured first.

Notifications



The notifications panel open on the right

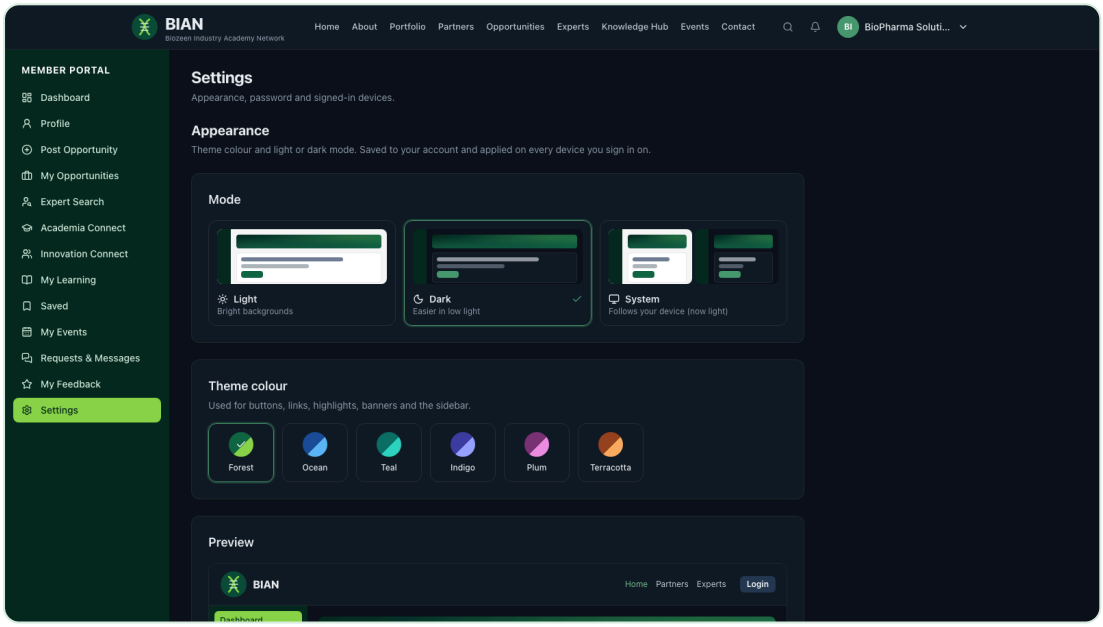
The **bell** in the header shows how many unread notifications you have. They arrive live, without reloading the page, and also pop up briefly at the bottom of the screen.

- Click the bell to open the **notifications panel** on the right. Switch between **All** and **Unread**.
- Click a notification to open the page it refers to; it is then marked as read.
- **Mark all read** clears the badge. Notifications are kept for 90 days.

You are told when…	Who receives it
Your membership is approved	The new member
The secretariat replies to your request, or its status changes	The member who sent it

You are told when…	Who receives it
Your submitted opportunity is published	The member who submitted it
Your expert profile is approved	The expert
A new announcement, opportunity or event is published for you	Every member in that item's audience
Someone registers and awaits approval	Staff who approve members
A contact, collaboration or expert-connect request comes in	Staff who handle requests
A member submits an opportunity for review	Staff who can publish
A member creates an expert profile	Staff who manage experts

Settings: appearance, password and devices



The Settings page with appearance options

Open **Settings** from your account menu (top right), or from the sidebar of your workspace.

Appearance

1. Choose a **mode**: *Light*, *Dark*, or *System* (follows your computer or phone).
2. Choose a **theme colour**: Forest (the BIAN default), Ocean, Teal, Indigo, Plum, Terracotta, or **Custom** (the last option) to pick any colour. With a custom colour, every shade is worked out from your pick, and very light colours are darkened so button text stays readable.
3. The **Preview** shows the header, banner, sidebar, cards, buttons and badges in your choice before you apply it.
4. Click **Apply theme**. Your choice is saved to your account and follows you to any device you sign in on. **Reset to default** returns to Forest with System mode.

Buttons, links, banners, the sidebar and highlights such as the selected menu item all follow the theme colour you choose. Visitors who aren't signed in keep their choice only until they close the browser tab.

Action icons use the same colours everywhere: **View** is blue, **Edit** amber, **Delete** red and **Analytics** violet.

Security: change your password (other devices are signed out), or **sign out of all devices**.

Category or role? Your *category* is what you chose when you registered (for example Student). Your *roles* decide what you can see and do. When you are approved you get the **Member** role plus the role for your category. An administrator can add or change roles later.